NORTHSTAR BANK

Credit Card Product Guide

Spend Categories · Billing Cycles · Rewards · Statements · Limits

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This document covers all aspects of NorthStar Bank credit card products relevant to spend analysis, billing, rewards, limits, and customer communication. It is intended as the primary knowledge base for the Credit Card Spend Summarizer capstone project (BFSI-CC-003).

SECTION 1: CARD VARIANTS & FEATURES

1.1 Card Portfolio Overview

NorthStar Bank offers four credit card variants targeting different customer segments — from everyday spenders to high-net-worth individuals. Each variant has a distinct fee structure, credit limit range, and rewards programme.

Card Variant	Target Segment	Annual Fee	Fee Waiver	Credit Limit Range
NorthStar Classic	First-time / students	Rs. 499 + GST	Spend ≥ Rs. 50,000/yr	Rs. 25,000 – Rs. 1,00,000

NorthStar Gold	Salaried professionals	Rs. 999 + GST	Spend ≥ Rs. 1,00,000/yr	Rs. 1,00,000 – Rs. 3,00,000
NorthStar Platinum	Senior professionals / HNI	Rs. 2,499 + GST	Spend ≥ Rs. 3,00,000/yr	Rs. 3,00,000 – Rs. 10,00,000
NorthStar Signature	Ultra-HNI / corporates	Rs. 5,000 + GST	Spend ≥ Rs. 7,00,000/yr	Rs. 10,00,000 & above

1.2 Key Features by Variant

Feature	Classic	Gold	Platinum	Signature
Complimentary Lounge Access (dom		None	4/year	12/year
Complimentary Lounge Access (intl)	None	None	2/year	6/year
Golf Programme	No	No	No	Yes (12 rounds/yr)
Concierge Service	No	No	Yes	Yes (24x7)
Zero Forex Markup	No	No	No	Yes
Fuel Surcharge Waiver	No	Yes (1-25% off)	Yes (1-25% off)	Yes (full waiver)
EMI Conversion (no-cost)	No	Yes (≥Rs. 5,000)	Yes (≥Rs. 3,000)	Yes (≥Rs. 2,000)
Add-on Cards	1	2	4	5

SECTION 2: SPEND CATEGORIES & CLASSIFICATION

2.1 Standard Spend Categories

NorthStar Bank classifies all credit card transactions into the following categories for spend analysis, rewards calculation, and monthly statement generation. The category is assigned based on the Merchant Category Code (MCC) of the transaction.

Category Code	Category Name	Example Merchants	MCC Range (indicative)
FOOD	Food & Dining	Swiggy, Zomato, Domino's, restaurants	5812, 5814, 5411
GROC	Groceries	BigBasket, D-Mart, Reliance Smart, M	
TRVL	Travel	IndiGo, Air India, IRCTC, MakeMyTrip,	
SHOP	Shopping	Amazon, Myntra, Flipkart, Nykaa, Croma	5940, 5691, 5045

ENTR	Entertainment	BookMyShow, Netflix, Hotstar, Spotify,	
FUEL	Fuel	BPCL, HPCL, Indian Oil, Shell	5541, 5542
HLTH	Health & Medical	Apollo Pharmacy, Practo, hospitals, labs	5912, 8099, 8011
EDUC	Education	BYJU'S, Coursera, schools, colleges	8220, 8211, 5942
UTIL	Utilities & Bills	BESCOM, Airtel, BSNL, Jio, LIC, insur	
JEWL	Jewellery	Tanishq, Kalyan Jewellers, Malabar Gold	
ELEC	Electronics	Croma, Reliance Digital, Apple Store	5731, 5065, 5734
AUTO	Automobile	Car service centres, petrol pumps, auto	
INTL	International	Any merchant billed in foreign currency	All MCCs (foreign)
CASH	Cash Advance	ATM withdrawals on credit card	6010, 6011
OTHR	Others	Transactions not matching a categories	

* MCC ranges are indicative. NorthStar Bank's internal classification engine may override MCC-based categorisation for certain merchants.

2.2 Category Spend Limits & Alerts

Customers can set monthly spend limits per category via the NorthStar mobile app. The system triggers an SMS/push notification when 80% and 100% of the category limit is reached.

Alert Type	Trigger	Channel
Category Limit 80%	80% of customer-set category limit reached	Push + SMS
Category Limit Exceeded	100% of category limit reached	Push + SMS + Email
Unusual Spend	Transaction >3x average in same category	Push + SMS
International Txn	Any transaction flagged as international	SMS (always)
Large Transaction	Single transaction > Rs. 50,000	Push + SMS

SECTION 3: BILLING CYCLE, STATEMENTS & PAYMENTS

3.1 Billing Cycle Structure

Each NorthStar credit card has a fixed billing cycle based on the card's statement generation date. The

billing cycle is 30 days, followed by a 20-day payment due period.

Event	Timeline	Example (Statement Date: 25th)
Billing Cycle Start	Day 1 of cycle	26th of previous month
Billing Cycle End	Day 30 of cycle	25th of current month
Statement Generation	Day 30 (end of cycle)	25th of current month
Payment Due Date	Statement Date + 20 days	15th of next month
Grace Period Ends	Same as Payment Due Date	15th of next month
Finance Charges Begin	Day after due date	16th of next month

* Transactions posted after the statement date will appear in the next month's statement.

* If the due date falls on a bank holiday or Sunday, the payment will be accepted on the next working day without penalty.

3.2 Statement Contents

Monthly statements are sent via email (PDF) and accessible on the NorthStar mobile app and net banking portal. Each statement contains:

• Summary section: Opening balance, total purchases, cash advances, payments, credits, fees, and closing balance

• Spend category breakdown: Total spend per category for the billing month with percentage of total • Transaction listing: Date, merchant name, category, amount, currency (for international), and running balance

• Minimum Amount Due (MAD): 5% of outstanding or Rs. 200 (whichever is higher) •

Reward points summary: Points earned this period, redeemed, expired, and total available •

EMI schedules: Active no-cost EMI plans with monthly instalments and remaining tenure •

Payment options: NEFT details, UPI VPA, QR code for quick payment

3.3 Payment Options & Due Dates

Payment Method	Processing Time	Credit to Card
NorthStar Net Banking	Instant	Immediate
UPI (any app)	Instant	Within 30 minutes
NEFT / RTGS	2–4 hours	Same day (business hours)
IMPS	Instant	Within 30 minutes
Cheque (branch drop)	2–3 working days	On clearance
Auto-Debit (NACH mandate)	On due date	On due date

* Auto-Debit can be set for Minimum Amount Due, Fixed Amount, or Total Outstanding.

SECTION 4: REWARDS PROGRAMME

4.1 Reward Points Earn Rate

Card Variant	Base Rate	Dining & Travel	International	Grocery & Fuel
Classic	1 pt / Rs. 100	1 pt / Rs. 100	1 pt / Rs. 100	1 pt / Rs. 100
Gold	1 pt / Rs. 100	2X (2 pts/Rs. 100)	2X (2 pts/Rs. 100)	1 pt / Rs. 100
Platinum	2 pts / Rs. 100	3X (6 pts/Rs. 100)	3X (6 pts/Rs. 100)	1 pt / Rs. 100
Signature	3 pts / Rs. 100	4X (12 pts/Rs. 100)	5X (15 pts/Rs. 100)	2 pts / Rs. 100

* 1 Reward Point = Rs. 0.25 redemption value against statement credit, vouchers, or product catalogue.

* Reward points are NOT earned on: fuel (surcharge portion), cash advances, EMI transactions, fees & charges, and tax payments.

4.2 Reward Point Redemption

Redemption Type	Min Points	Value per Point	Notes
Statement Credit	500 pts	Rs. 0.25	Credited to card account within 2 wo
Partner Vouchers	200 pts	Rs. 0.30	Amazon, Flipkart, Myntra, Swiggy, Zomato
Airline Miles	1,000 pts	1:1 mile	Air India Flying Returns, IndiGo 6 Rewar
Hotel Points	1,000 pts	1:2 pts	Marriott Bonvoy, IHG Rewards
Product Catalogue	500 pts	Rs. 0.20	Electronics, appliances, gift cards

4.3 Points Expiry Policy

- Points earned in a calendar year expire on December 31st of the following year (18–24 month window).
- Points are forfeited immediately on card closure or if the account becomes delinquent (90+ days past due).
- Bonus points from promotional campaigns may have shorter expiry periods — check campaign T&Cs.;
- Points expiry reminders are sent 60 days and 30 days before expiry via email and push notification.

SECTION 5: FEES, CHARGES & FINANCE COSTS

5.1 Complete Fee Schedule

Charge Type	Classic	Gold	Platinum	Signature
Annual Fee	Rs. 499	Rs. 999	Rs. 2,499	Rs. 5,000
Add-on Card Fee	Rs. 199/card	Rs. 499/card	Rs. 999/card	NIL
Finance Charge (monthly)	3.49%	3.49%	3.25%	3.00%
Cash Advance Fee	2.5% (min Rs. 500)	2.5% (min Rs. 500)	2.5% (min Rs. 500)	2.0% (min Rs. 500)
Foreign Currency Markup	3.50%	3.50%	3.50%	0% (waived)
Late Payment (>Rs. 10,000 due)	Rs. 1,200	Rs. 1,200	Rs. 1,000	Rs. 750
Over-Limit Fee	2.5% (min Rs. 500)	2.5% (min Rs. 500)	2.0% (min Rs. 500)	NIL
Duplicate Statement	Rs. 100	Rs. 100	NIL	NIL
Card Replacement	Rs. 200	Rs. 200	NIL	NIL

* Finance charges apply only when full outstanding is not paid by due date (revolving credit). * GST @ 18% is applicable on all fees and charges.

5.2 Late Payment Fee Slab

Outstanding Amount Due	Late Payment Fee
Up to Rs. 500	NIL
Rs. 501 – Rs. 5,000	Rs. 500
Rs. 5,001 – Rs. 10,000	Rs. 750
Above Rs. 10,000	Rs. 1,200 (Classic/Gold) | Rs. 1,000 (Platinum) | Rs. 750 (Signature)

SECTION 6: SPEND SUMMARY — BUSINESS RULES

6.1 How Monthly Spend Summaries Are Computed

The Credit Card Spend Summarizer computes summaries from raw transaction data using the following business rules:

• Include only transactions with txn_type = 'purchase' in spend totals. Exclude: payments, refunds, fees, cash advances.

• Refunds (txn_type = 'refund') reduce the net spend in the corresponding category. • International transactions are flagged separately (is_international = TRUE) and reported as a sub-total.

• EMI transactions are counted as single spend at the time of purchase, not per monthly instalment.

• Transactions in foreign currency are converted to INR at the rate on the transaction date. • Category is assigned by the system; the merchant_name field is used for human-readable summaries.

6.2 Sample Spend Summary Output Format

A well-formed spend summary for a billing month should include the following elements:

Summary Element	Description	Example
Total Spend	Sum of all purchases this month	Rs. 42,300
Top Category	Category with highest spend	Travel (Rs. 17,500 — 41%)
No. of Transactions	Count of purchase transactions	18 transactions
Avg Transaction Value	Total spend / no. of transactions	Rs. 2,350 average
International Spend	Total of is_international = TRUE txns	Rs. 8,200 (2 transactions)
Largest Single Purchase	Max amount in purchase transactions	Rs. 12,000 — Amazon UK
Reward Points Earned	Points from this month's spend	846 points (≈ Rs. 212 value)

Category Breakdown	Spend per category as % of total	See table below
Month-over-Month Change	vs. previous billing month spend	+12% vs. last month

6.3 Sample Category Breakdown Table (Statement Insert)

Category	No. of Txns	Total Spend	% of Total	Reward Pts Earned
Travel	3	Rs. 17,500	41.4%	350 pts
Shopping	4	Rs. 10,200	24.1%	204 pts
Food & Dining	5	Rs. 6,300	14.9%	189 pts
Entertainment	2	Rs. 3,700	8.7%	74 pts
Groceries	2	Rs. 2,900	6.9%	58 pts
Utilities	1	Rs. 1,700	4.0%	17 pts (capped)
TOTAL	17	Rs. 42,300	100%	892 pts

* Reward points for utilities and insurance categories are capped at 500 points per statement month across all such transactions.

6.4 Edge Cases & Handling Rules

Scenario	Handling Rule
Partial refund on a purchase	Net spend = Original amount minus refund amount; category unchanged
Merchant recategorised mid-cycle	Use category at time of posting, not at time of statement generation
Transaction dispute raised	Disputed amount excluded from spend summary until resolved
No transactions in a category	Category omitted from breakdown; not shown as Rs. 0
Split payment (partial by points)	Only cash component counted in spend summary
Cancelled transaction not reversed	Excluded from summary once cancellation confirmed by merchant

SECTION 7: CREDIT LIMIT MANAGEMENT

7.1 Credit Limit Types

Limit Type	Definition
Total Credit Limit	Maximum outstanding allowed on the card at any time
Available Credit Limit	Total Limit minus current outstanding balance

Cash Limit	20% of total credit limit (usable for cash advances)
Available Cash Limit	Cash Limit minus cash advances already drawn
International Limit	Sub-limit for foreign currency transactions (default = Total Limit)

7.2 Credit Limit Enhancement

- Customers may request a limit increase after 6 months of card usage with a clean repayment track record.
- Auto limit enhancement offered to eligible customers (CIBIL ≥ 750, no missed payments in 12 months).
- Limit increase requires fresh income proof if enhancement exceeds 50% of current limit.
- Temporary limit enhancement available for travel or wedding spend — valid up to 60 days.

SECTION 8: SAMPLE CUSTOMER SCENARIOS

8.1 Scenario Library for Spend Summarizer Testing

The following scenarios are provided to help trainees test their spend summariser with realistic inputs and expected outputs.

Scenario A — Heavy Travel Month

Account	Card	Billing Period	Total Spend	Top Category	Intl Txns
CC-881001	Gold	Mar 1–Mar 25, 2026	Rs. 42,300	Travel (41%)	2 (SGD + GBP)

Expected summary: Travel dominates; flag international markup charges; reward multiplier applied on travel (2X for Gold).

Scenario B — Routine Monthly Spend

Account	Card	Billing Period	Total Spend	Top Category	Intl Txns
CC-882001	Platinum	Mar 1–Mar 25, 2026	Rs. 28,700	Shopping (35%)	None

Expected summary: No unusual patterns; reward points 3X on dining category; EMI conversion eligible for Rs. 12,000 purchase.

Scenario C — Low Spend / Near Fee Waiver Threshold

Account	Card	YTD Spend	Fee Waiver Target	Remaining	Months Left
CC-883001	Classic	Rs. 38,200	Rs. 50,000	Rs. 11,800	3 months

Expected summary: Alert customer they are Rs. 11,800 short of fee waiver threshold with 3 billing cycles remaining.